

USER GUIDE

Buskit App User Guide

Bronze Edition | Silver Edition | Gold Edition



Metronome • Tuner • Diapason • Backing Track • Drum Machine • Arrangement • Live Effects

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How to read this guide

Bronze Silver Gold Shows which edition of the app includes a section or feature.

Save Names of buttons and options inside the app appear in this style.

`download/Buskit/…` Folder where files are saved in the phone's storage.

Note Warning Coloured boxes highlight important notes and warnings.

1 Connecting Your Instrument & Getting Started

To use the app's features on the sound of your instrument or voice, first bring the sound into your phone using one of the following methods:

1 Phone microphone

The simplest way is to use the phone's own microphone. In the app, set the input source (hamburger menu) to “Automatic” or “Internal microphone”, and connect the phone's output either to headphones (to hear the output privately) or, using a stereo cable with a 3.5 mm jack, to the AUX input, microphone input or guitar input of any amplifier or personal speaker.
The sound of your instrument or voice can now travel through the phone's microphone to your headphones or speaker. In this way your phone acts as a high-quality microphone together with a feature-rich mixer.

2 Using earphones with a microphone

Plug the earphones into the phone, launch the app, set the input source (hamburger menu) to “Automatic” or “External microphone”, and load the effect or rhythm you want. The sound of your instrument is now captured by the earphones' microphone, and the mixed audio output can be heard through the headphones.

3 Using an iRig device

If your instrument has a piezo pickup (adhesive, under-bridge or clip-on), or you want to send the sound of an instrument or voice to the app through a dynamic microphone, get a small iRig device, which is easy to find in stores, and bring the sound into the app with it.
Connect the device's cable to the phone, plug the microphone into its microphone input, and connect its output to headphones or a speaker/amplifier.

Note If none of the earphones, headphones or iRig is connected to the phone's headphone jack when you start the app, you may hear loud noise. This is normal, because positive feedback has been created.

2 Getting to Know the App's Sections

The app consists of **seven sections**. Each section opens when you tap its icon in the menu bar of the main screen. Below we explain how to use the features and controls of each section:



Metronome

Generates metronome beats at 40 to 500 beats per minute, with additional features.



Tuner

Tunes your instrument and displays the frequency of the sound received from it, with additional features.



Diapason

Generates every pitch from A0 to C8, by cents and in different reference frequencies.



Backing Track

Loads up to 8 separate backing-track or rhythm lanes so you can play each one and play along with them.



Drum Machine

Creates rhythmic patterns using drum techniques, with practical features.



Arrangement

Builds a harmonic backing track by entering chords for every beat of a piece of your choice.

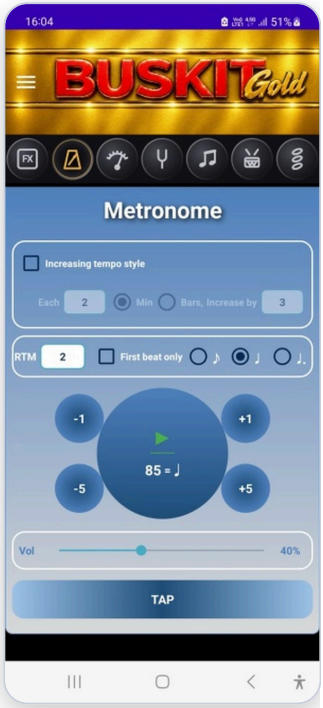


Effects

20 popular, widely used effects from the world of playing and music, with every parameter adjustable.

3 Metronome

Tap the icon in the main screen's menu bar and the metronome controls appear. This section has **5 parts**:



Metronome screen

1. **Centre circle:** It has two roles: it is the on/off button of the metronome, and a long press on it lets you change the tempo number manually. The +1 −1 +5 −5 buttons increase or decrease the current tempo.
2. **Volume slider:** Sets the metronome volume from zero to maximum. You can also tap the volume number to type a value.
3. **TAP button:** Tap it repeatedly to set the tempo.
4. **RTM:** Sets the rhythmic pattern you want. It can be a combination of up to 5 non-zero digits, each representing one beat of the bar; the digits do not have to be equal.

- A single digit, e.g. “4”, means a 4-beat bar.
- With several digits, each digit represents one beat of the bar. For example “223” is a 7-beat bar: the first two beats have two parts each and the third beat has three parts, played as 12 - 12 - 123.
- The default is 2, a simple two-beat bar.

Example: bar “223” → strong, weak, medium, weak, medium, weak, weak

1 2 1 2 1 2 3

Strong Medium Weak i.e. three different click sounds

With the **First beat only** checkbox ticked, only the strong and medium beats sound and the weak beats are skipped. For the 7-beat bar 223, for instance, you hear only three clicks: the first strong and the next two medium.

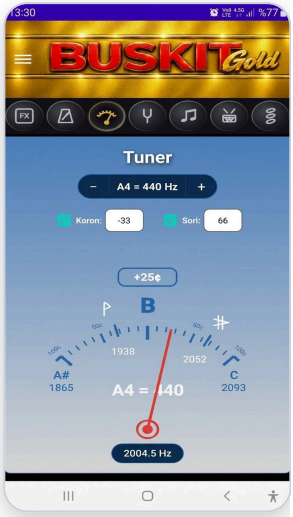
Choosing the eighth-note or dotted-quarter-note value changes the base note of the metronome, so the beats per minute are counted for that note value.

5. **Automatic tempo change:** Tick the box and set three parameters — a duration (in minutes) or a number of bars played, and the tempo increase amount. After the set time or number of bars has passed, the current tempo is increased automatically by the given amount.

Edition This part (automatic tempo change) is not available in the **Bronze edition**.

4 Tuner

Tap the icon in the menu bar of the main screen and the tuner controls appear. This section has **three parts**:



Tuner screen

1. Setting the **reference frequency of A4** (the note A in octave 4) using the + and - buttons.
2. With the “Sori” and “Koron” checkboxes you choose whether these pitches (quarter-tone sharp and quarter-tone flat, used in Persian music) are detected, and you can set the deviation of each main note in cents.
3. When you play your instrument, **the needle of the scale** stops on the frequency of that note. If the received sound is within 5 cents of the main note or of its sori or koron, the needle turns **green** and a green circle appears around that note, showing it is in tune. The frequency of every note on the screen is also displayed.

Edition Parts 1 and 2 are not available in the **Bronze edition**.

5 Diapason

Silver Gold

Tap the icon in the main screen's menu bar and the diapason controls appear.



Diapason screen

The microtonal diapason covers **8 octaves** and generates any requested pitch in different reference frequencies, with three waveforms: Sine Triangle Square. A pulse (Pulse) mode is also available, and the frequency of each pitch is displayed. Tap “Play” to sound the selected note.

Note Low-frequency pitches (octaves 0 to 2) cannot be heard through the speaker of most phones and tablets because of speaker limitations, but they can be heard through headphones or earphones.

Edition This section is not available in the **Bronze edition**.

6 Backing Track

Tap the icon in the main screen's menu bar and the backing-track controls appear. Here you can load **8 backing tracks** or rhythms at the same time and play along with them.

Warning Just load one or a few bars of a rhythm and it plays as a loop with no time limit.



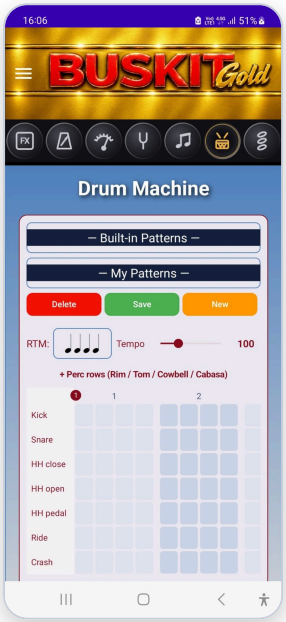
Backing Track screen

Selecting a track	Tap a track's number to select it.
Play button	Plays the selected track. While it is playing you can select another track and continue with the new one.
Volume	The volume of each track can be changed during playback.
Changing playback speed	There are two ways to change the speed: **with a frequency change** and **without a frequency change**. You choose it from the menu (see the “App Menu” chapter).
3-band equalizer	To improve playback quality, this equalizer is applied to the loaded track's sound.
Presets	With the **Save** button you can save the list of backing tracks together with their volume, file and playback speed into a file with a name of your choice in the folder `download/Buskit/BTpreset`. To load a saved preset, tap the list so the available presets appear, then tap the preset name. The **Delete** button removes the selected preset.
Backing-track files	To make files easier to reuse, they are copied after selection into the folder `download/Buskit/rhythm` in the phone's storage, so they are easy to reach next time.

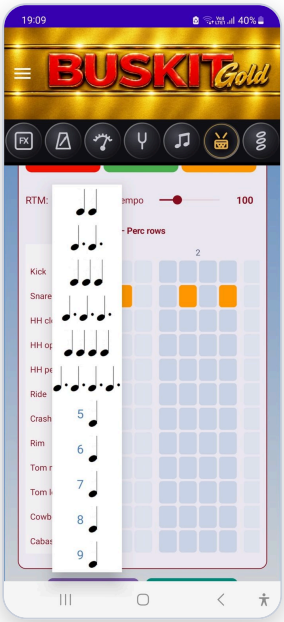
7 Drum Machine

Gold edition only

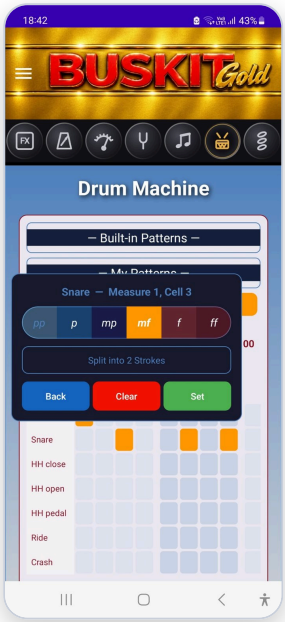
Tap to enter this section. Here you can create any drum pattern with the usual techniques, in two bars and according to the app's chosen RTM. If you program only one bar, the second bar is ignored. **(This section is available only in the Gold edition.)**



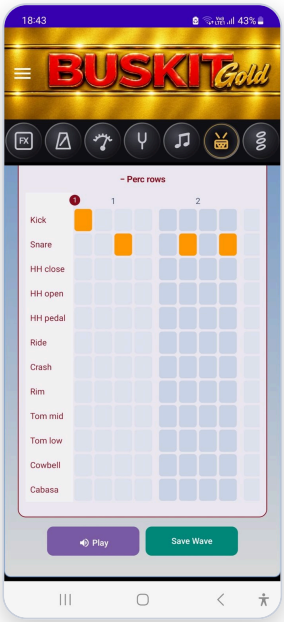
Drum machine main screen



Choosing the rhythm (RTM)



Editing a cell



Ready pattern and playback

Building a pattern

Choosing RTM	Choose the rhythmic pattern with RTM.
Tempo	Set the playback speed with the tempo slider. Tapping the tempo number opens a small window where you can type the tempo directly.
Main techniques	The main techniques you can use to build a pattern are: ride · crash · Kick · snare · HH close · HH open · HH pedal
Percussion techniques	The percussion techniques you can use are the following (they appear when you tap the Perc rows text): rim · tom mid · tom low · cowbell · cabasa

Pattern grid	For every beat, counted as a quarter note, 4 cells at sixteenth-note timing are shown as a grid. Tap a cell and the technique is activated at mf volume. Tapping an active cell opens a window with these options: • Adjust the volume • Turn that cell into two hits at thirty-second-note timing • Turn the selected cell and the next one into a triplet (three hits in the time of two sixteenth notes) • Remove that technique from the cell (`Clear` button) • Apply the changes to the selected cell (`Set` button)

Patterns and output

Ready-made patterns	The list at the top contains pre-written patterns; choosing one shows its pattern in the technique grid, where you can edit or change it as you like.
Save	Saves the pattern in the folder `download/Buskit/DrumPreset` so it can be restored later.
New	Starts a brand-new pattern; all cells of the pattern are cleared.
Play	Plays the pattern at the speed set by the tempo slider.
Wave output	The `Save Wave` button saves the pattern as a Wave file that you can use as a backing track.

8 Arrangement

Gold edition only

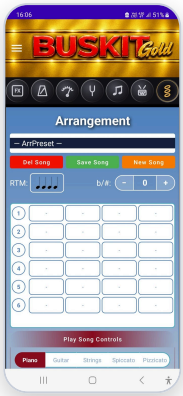


Tap  to enter this section. It lets you set up a piece as a harmonised backing track together with a rhythm. **(This section is available only in the Gold edition.)**

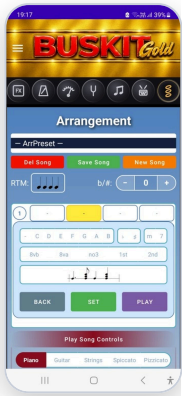
- When you choose a rhythmic pattern in RTM, a box is shown on the screen for every beat of the piece. The numbers on the left are bar numbers, and each row represents one bar.

Entering a chord

1. Tap a box and a window opens in which you configure the chord you want, including first and second inversions, power chords, minor, major and seventh chords.
2. Tap the box above the three buttons to tell the app the rhythmic pattern for that bar. Tap **Play** to hear the selected chord.
3. Then tap **Set** to place the chord in the chord grid.



Arrangement screen

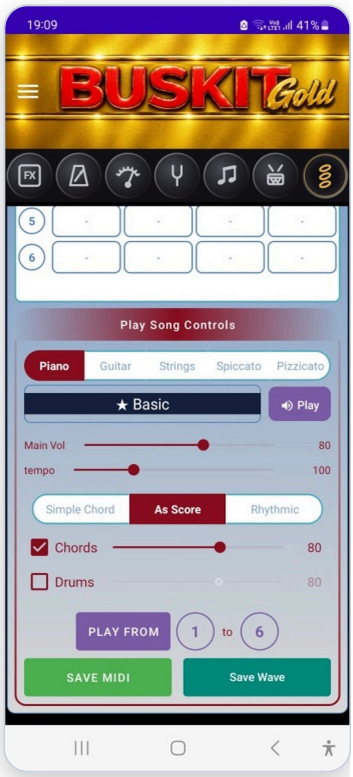


Entering a chord

Playing the piece

Scroll the screen up to see the controls for playing the arranged piece. It plays with **5 instrument sounds** (guitar, piano, strings, spiccato and staccato), using the rhythmic patterns you chose or recorded in the piece, or as simple chords.

Transpose	You can transpose the written piece in semitones with the stepper. Increase or decrease the number of semitones in the #/b box to transpose the whole piece.
Drum pattern	Choose a drum pattern from the list and add it to the piece.
Tempo slider	Sets the playback speed.
Chords & Drums	The checkboxes mute the chords or the rhythm, and the slider next to each sets its volume.
Play From	Enter the start and end bar numbers in the round boxes next to it, then tap the button to play only that part.
Save MIDI / Wave	Saves the whole piece as a MIDI or Wave file in the folders `download/Buskit/Midi` and `download/Buskit/Arrangement`.

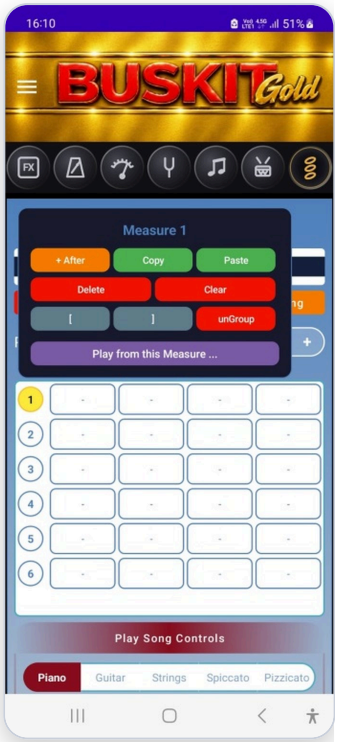


Piece playback controls

Bar editing tools

To make writing chords easier and faster there are tools such as copy, delete, paste and grouping. Their window appears when you tap a bar number:

+After	Creates an empty bar after the current bar.
Copy	Stores the current bar in the clipboard.
Paste	Puts the clipboard contents into the current bar.
Clear	Clears only the contents of the current bar.
Delete	Removes the whole bar from the piece, so the piece has one bar fewer.
Play from this measure	Plays the piece from the selected bar to the end.



Bar tools window

Grouping bars

To split the bars of a long piece into smaller sections (for example verse 1, chorus…) or to select a range of bars to copy, delete or clear:

1. In the first bar of the group, tap the **[** button.
2. In the last bar of the group, tap the **]** button.
3. Finally, in the window that opens, tap **Group**. You can also name the group.

Expand	Tap the grouped section and press this button; the group opens and its bars are shown for editing or review.
Collapse	Tap any bar of the opened group (its number turns blue) and press this button; the group is collapsed again.
Deleting or clearing a selected range	If you select a range with the **[** **]** keys and press **Delete**, all the selected bars are removed from the piece; if you press **Clear**, only the contents of those bars are cleared.

9 Effects



The app includes **20 popular, widely used effects**. Tap the “Effects” button and a grid of effects appears. Tap an effect's name: its colour changes, the effect is activated and added to the **processing chain**, and its adjustable parameters appear at the bottom of the screen. Tap again to deactivate it and remove it from the chain.

List of effects

The effects available in each edition are:

Bronze edition

Noise Gate · Compressor · 9-band Equalizer · Phaser · Reverb · Delay · Warm Overdrive · Limiter · Fuzz Distortion

Silver edition — In addition to all Bronze-edition effects

Wah-Wah · Vibrato · Chorus · Flanger · Exciter · Low-Pass Filter · Classic Overdrive · Tube Overdrive · Hard Distortion · Pitch Shifter (transpose, harmonizer, octaver)

Gold edition — In addition to all Silver-edition effects

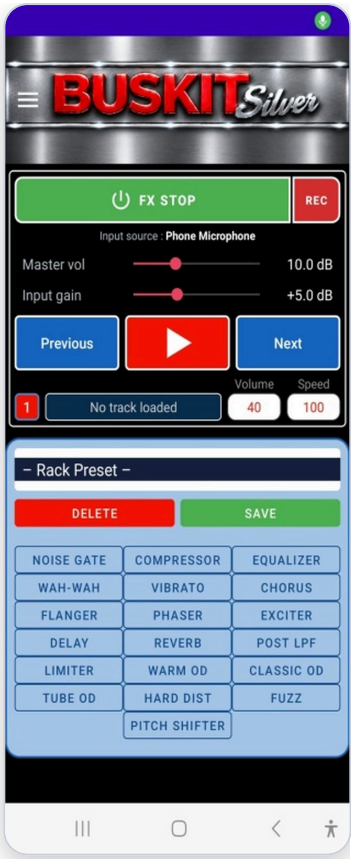
Cabinet (9 models)

Starting input sound processing

Tap the START button and the audio processing system starts and gets ready to receive the input sound from the microphone. At the same time a control panel opens, giving you the controls you need for live performance.

Until you tap start/stop again or close the app screen, the input volume, output volume, backing-track selection and play/stop, and sound recording are all controlled together from this panel.

Record (REC)	Tap `REC` and everything being played is recorded in WAV format in the phone's storage.
Gain control	The **Input Gain** slider (drive) at the start of the effects chain raises the signal level entering the system, and **Output Gain** at the end of the path raises the volume of the processed sound.
Rack preset	This part has a preset list and two buttons, `Save` and `Delete`. Save stores the state of all effects and their parameters in the folder `download/Buskit/ArPreset` so you can load it later; Delete removes the current preset from the phone's storage.



Effects control panel and rack

Warning The metronome sound is never present in the saved file; it plays only to guide the musician.

Warning Too much gain can affect the quality of the output sound.

Warning For the equalizer effect you can also save the parameters of each band separately from the rack presets.

The effects chain

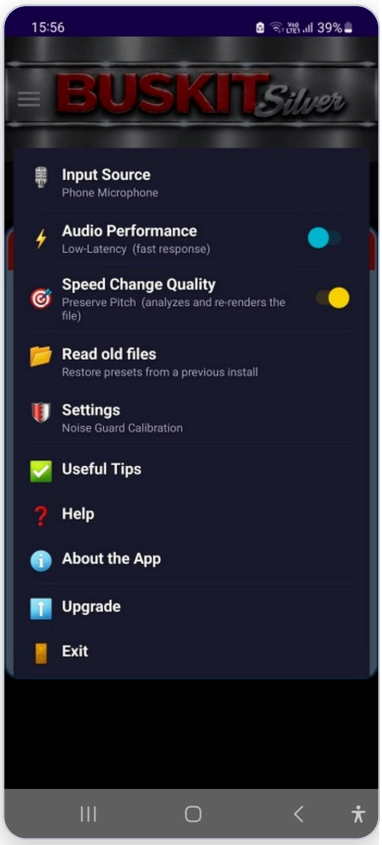
After entering, your instrument's sound passes through the active effects in this order. Effects that are not active are skipped.



10 App Menu

The menu gives you access to the following:

Input Source	**Choosing the sound input:** internal microphone, external microphone or automatic selection.
Audio Performance	Adjusts the audio system's performance. It is meant for older or slower phones, to improve output sound quality and reduce the app's latency. If the processed sound crackles, change the state of this item's switch in the menu.
Speed Change Quality	**How the backing-track tempo is changed:** when needed, this switch lets you slow down or speed up playback by up to 30% without changing the frequency. **Warning:** changing speed without changing frequency takes about 15 to 20 seconds, depending on the length of the backing-track file.
Read old files	**Reading old files:** if for any reason you had to reinstall the app, or after an update you need to read previously created presets or rhythms, choose this item and give the app the required access on your phone's operating system.
Settings	**Hum and noise:** if there is unwanted noise or hum in the output sound, you can correct and save it by changing 4 parameters without affecting output quality. However, **we strongly recommend not changing them**, because the default values suit most phones.
Useful Tips	View and read practical tips.
Help	View and read how to use the app.
About the App	Shows the active license, its type, the version number and the app update.
Upgrade	Lets you upgrade your license.
Exit	Exits the app.



App menu

11 Licenses

The app has **4 types** of license:

TRIALS	Bronze license	Silver license	Gold license
Trial			

TRIALS All features of the app can be used, but it expires and is deactivated after **5 days**. Its purpose is to let you test your phone and its compatibility with the app and try out the features, so that before buying you can judge the quality and compatibility on your own phone.

Moving a license A license can be active on only **one device** at a time. To move a license from one device to another, first tap `Log out` on the first screen; the license is then released from this device and can be installed on another one.

12 Practical Tips & Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Crackling in the output sound	From the menu, open `Audio Performance`, change the state of its switch and test again. If the problem persists, exit the app once and re-enter.
Sound cutting out	Do not set the output gain or pre-amp too high, especially when using overdrive or distortion.
Noise when starting without an instrument	This is normal (see the “Connecting Your Instrument & Getting Started” chapter).
Annoying hum or noise	Read the menu's `Settings` item.

13 Important Note About Presets

Important How well the app's presets perform depends on many factors, including the type of instrument, the playing environment, how the sound is picked up from the instrument, the sound system, and even the type of pick and your playing technique. So treat the presets only as **a starting template for your own settings**.



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